

INTO THE BLUE

For WTiCabs Founder and CEO Ashok Vashist, scuba diving is not just an adventure sport. It is a pathway to connect with the ocean

BY NIDHI SINGAL

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In the tranquil depths beneath the surface lies a realm ripe for discovery. It's within this submerged world of marine marvels that Ashok Vashist, the Founder and CEO of the cab-hailing start-up WTiCabs, finds peace. With 50 dives under his belt, Vashist, a certified scuba diver, has ventured into the depths of destinations like the Andamans, Phuket in Thailand, and Bali in Indonesia.

For Vashist, scuba diving isn't just a hobby; it's a family legacy. Inspired by his father's distinguished service in the Indian Navy as both a proficient instructor and an adept diver and swimmer, Vashist found his calling beneath the waves.

"Growing up in coastal areas, I naturally developed a profound love for the sea. Therefore, it was only natural for me to choose scuba diving as my passion, as it allows me to explore the depths of the sea, a realm I've always felt drawn to since childhood," he says.

Vashist's inaugural scuba dive took place during his certification course on Havelock Island in the Andamans. But why did he opt for certification? Vashist's decision stemmed from his profound affection for the ocean and a deep yearning to delve into its depths, albeit with assurance and proficiency. Recognising that certification would furnish him with the requisite expertise and preparation for safe diving, he decided to go for it.

"The certification not only boosted my confidence as a diver but also opened up opportunities to dive in a wider range of locations," he says.

Vashist has also invested in his diving gear, which includes a high-quality wetsuit, fins, mask, regulator, and dive computer, that ensures not only ensures safety, but also enhances his diving experience.

But what is this deeper connect with the ocean that he feels? Vashist points out that scuba diving has given

OCEAN CALLING Ashok Vashist standing amidst the vast blue Indian Ocean, preparing for his next dive



UNDERSEA ADVENTURES A shot taken during one of Vashist's dives. As a diver, he loves to push himself, going deeper into the ocean

VASHIST HAS ALWAYS BEEN FASCINATED WITH THE OCEAN AND DIVING IS A WAY TO FORGE A DEEPER CONNECTION WITH HIS CHILDHOOD